

Ranged Attack Summary

To conclude, every time a unit is targeted by a Ranged Attack, resolve Successful Hits/Wounds first. Next, roll Will checks for every round with Deflected Hits, placing Pinned Counters for Failed Checks. Misses are a waste of good ammunition. Aim better next time, comrade!

- **Ranged Attack Successful Hit** = Wound or Casualty
- **Ranged Attack Deflected Hit** = Possible Pinned Counter
- **Miss** = Miss

Time To Kit Up?

You want reliable guns and gear, you need to see the Turk.

AKs, Saigas, ammo, grenades, body armor, GLONASS satnav sets...Zakhar has everything and what he doesn't have he can get. Even military kit, if you've got the Script.

Go eleven kilometers on the Number Three East road. There's an old petrol station at the top of the hill. That's his trading post.

When you come to the front gate, keep your weapon slung and your hands visible. The password is 'Cheeki Breeki'.

The place looks battered but don't let that fool you; there's a dozen guards, reinforced walls, and MON-50 mines sprinkled everywhere. That gas station has survived a hundred attacks. It'll survive a hundred more.

Zakhar won't be cheap, but the gear he sells will work. And that's what's important.

Part 5: Armory, Body Armor, And Indirect Fire Weapons

5.1 The Armory

Now we get to the crunchy part. Below is the Armory section. While Russian-flavored, *Zona Alfa* does not differentiate between types of Assault Rifles (AK74 vs Vintorez VSS) or handguns (Makarov vs Grach) and the like. The rules are not tied to a proprietary range of figures, so Weapon and Armor types are broad, catch-all categories to allow gamers to use their coolest miniatures. Remember the WYSIWYG Rule and stat out your models according to the closest appropriate Weapon/Armor type listed. Tweak Damage,

Range, and Firepower to customize your character's firearm, but only so long as the other players agree!

Notes before you continue: weapons marked 'Melee' can only be used in Melee combat (makes sense, right?). Certain ranged weapons such as Pistols, Sub-machineguns, and Shotguns can be also used in Melee with no penalty. Other ranged weapons such as assault rifles incur a -2 penalty to the attacker's Combat Ability when used in close combat. Where the weapon calls for a "template" – be that a teardrop Flame, a Small Blast, or a Large Blast – the sizes and shapes referenced are commonly used in other game systems and are readily available (for sizes please see page 7). If you are partial to another, particular set of sizes, feel free to use them so long as they are used consistently.

Melee Weapon Table			
Weapon	Range	Firepower	Damage
Knife, Claws/Teeth	Melee	1/weapon	0
Machete, Big Claws/Teeth	Melee	1/weapon	1
Very Big Claws/Teeth	Melee	1/weapon	2
Pistol	Melee-12"	1/weapon	0
Magnum Pistol	Melee-12"	1/weapon	1
Shotgun	Melee-12"	3	3 at melee-6" 2 at 6+"
SMG	Melee-18"	4	0

Rifle Table			
Weapon	Range	Firepower	Damage
Assault Rifle (AK 74)	1-36"	3	1
Battle Rifle (AK-15)	1-48"	2	2

Support Weapon Table				
Weapon	Range	Firepower	Damage	Special Rules
Flame Thrower or Chemical Sprayer	Flame Template	NA	3/model/flame template	Limited Ammo, Support Weapon, Burn
40mm Grenade Launcher	4-24"	1	1/model. SBT	Indirect Fire, Reload, Limited Ammo, Support Weapon
Squad LMG (RPD or RPK)	1-48"	4	1	Support Weapon
Rocket Launcher (RPG)	4-48"	1	4 (anti-armor)	Reload, Limited Ammo, Support Weapon
Rocket Launcher (RPG)	4-48"	1	2/model SBT (anti-inf.)	Reload, Limited Ammo, Support Weapon, SBT
Sniper Rifle (Dragunov SVD-63)	1-60"	1	4	Support Weapon
HMG	1-60"	4	3	Crew Served
Mortar	6-60"	1	2/model LBT	Crew Served, Indirect Fire, Reload, Limited Ammo

Grenades and Explosives

Crew members can carry up to two (2) grenades of any type for free. Grenades come in pairs and the first set **does not** use an Equipment Slot (see Section 6.2, page 31). Additional sets of Grenades do use an Equipment Slot. Grenade types can be mixed as desired. Track their use on a character's Stat sheet. All Grenades and Explosives are capable of Indirect Fire (see page 27).

Grenades and Explosives Table			
Weapon	Range	Firepower	Damage
Molotov Cocktail	1-18"	1	SBT 1/model. BURN
Flash Bang	1-18"	1	SBT Auto 1Pinned/model
Smoke Grenade	1-18"	1	LBT/Smoke Blocks LOS/Will check -2 for any model caught in LBT.
Hand Grenade	1-18"	1	SBT 2/model
Satchel Charge	2-12"	1	LBT 3/model

Weapon Special Rules

Indirect Fire Weapon

See Section 5.4, page 27.

Reload

One Action must be spent after each Shooting Attack to reload this weapon.

Limited Ammo

Five (5) Rounds per Load-Out.

Support Weapon

Due to weight and or awkward size, models equipped with one of these weapons have their Movement rate reduced by 1" per Action.

Crew Served

Crew Served weapons are stationary positions. No movement possible.

Small Blast Template and Large Blast Template (SBT/LBT)

Small 3" diameter Blast Template, Large 5" diameter Blast Template.

When determining targets for Area Effect weapons, any and all models under or touched by the blast template must roll for Damage.

Flame Template

Approximately 8" long and 3" at its widest point, and tear drop shaped. No Combat Ability roll is necessary to place a teardrop template. Simply place the template as desired with the small end touching the base of the Attacker and orient as to maximize casualties. Any and all models under or touched by the template must roll for Damage.

Burn

All affected models under/touched by template must keep rolling Armor Rolls until they have suffered their last Wound (and go Out of Action) or until they make a successful Armor Save.

Penalty for Non-Melee Weapons

Unless the weapon range lists 'Melee', attacks with a Ranged Weapon in Melee Combat suffer a -2 penalty to Attacker's Combat Ability.

5.2 Terrain Features and Area Effect Weapons

Terrain items will modify or block a template's Area of Effect. Models caught in an Area Effect Template but behind Soft Cover receive a +2 bonus to the Armor Save roll. Hard and Hardened Cover will completely block the blast effect. This means it's possible for one of your troopers to toss a grenade into a nearby room or drop it over an adjacent brick wall and not be affected.

5.3 Body Armor

Most modern militaries and police forces are equipped with some form of body armor. Even well-equipped street gangs, crime cartels, and private security have access to quality body armor. Below are the seven types of Body Armor/Tactical Wear for *Zona Alfa*.

Body Armor Types

- **Basic BDU/Foul Weather Gear:** No Armor Save (except the Critical Success roll of 1). Counts as an Obscured Target from Ranged Attacks when in Cover.

Powered Weapons
Most Sci-Fi or Near Future settings offer hi-tech versions of standard weapons like a Gauss Rifle or Laser Pistol. My solution to keep the game balanced is to grant powered versions of weapons increased Damage ratings but off set that by requiring a Reload Action between each shot. Flavor to taste, but we have found it best to make such weapons extremely rare and experimental.

- **Salvaged/Improvised Body Armor:** Scrounged ballistic nylon and ceramic plates sewn into tactical vests, battle dress, and foul weather clothing provide Armor 3 and renders the wearer an Obscured Target when in Cover. Most Zone Hostile Bandits and Raiders employ Improvised Body Armor.
- **Civilian/Commercial Body Armor:** Armor 5 and the unit counts as an Obscured Target from Ranged Attacks when in Cover.
- **Military Body Armor:** Armor 6 and the unit counts as an Obscured Target from Ranged Attacks when in Cover.
- **Advanced Body Armor:** Armor 7 with a -1" penalty to Move Stat but also the unit counts as an Obscured Target from Ranged Attacks when in Cover. Grants 1 extra die to Armor Save rolls, choosing best result.
- **Mimetic Camo:** Armor 4 **plus** Counts as an Obscured Target for **any** Melee or Ranged Combat. Cumulative with regular cover and obstruction modifiers.
- **Military Exo Suit:** (Power Assisted Advanced Body Armor) Armor 7 with a +2" bonus to Move stat. **PLUS** counts as Obscured Target from Ranged Attacks when in Cover. Does not need to make a Will check for Deflected Hits. Grants 1 Extra die to Armor Save rolls. Choose best result.

Obscured Target When in Cover

Models wearing BDU's made with disruptive pattern material receive a benefit when in Cover and targeted by a Ranged Attack from an appropriate angle. Similar to an Obstruction, an Obscured Target gives a -1 penalty to a Ranged Attacker's Combat Ability Roll. This modifier is additional to and cumulative with standard Cover modifiers.

Toughened Hide, Shells, Chitinous Plates

Mutants and other Zone creatures have developed natural protection, be that camouflage coloration, chameleon-like pigmentation, or just plain old thick skin. This makes them notoriously tough to kill. Remember the WYSIWYG rule and stat out your Zone Hostiles with the closest appropriate Armor type.

Armor Ratings for Drones, Robots and Light Vehicles

As mentioned, *Zona Alfa* is a small unit skirmish game. Large vehicles and heavy armor bump the scale of battle beyond its intended scope. However, light equipment like drones, remote-controlled robots, and smaller vehicles such as bikes, jeeps, single operator heavy armor suits and walkers are certainly appropriate in small numbers. To that end, here are the suggested Armor Ratings for small vehicles.

Small Drone or Robot: Armor 3. Medium, human-sized robot: Armor 4. An enclosed truck or jeep: Armor 4, 5, or 6, depending on its size and if it is up-arm. A Light Walker, Piloted Exo Suit, or IFV should have an Armor rating of 6 or 7, and possibly two Wounds with diminished abilities in the same manners as a Cr Leader (see page 21).

Players are certainly free to include whatever figs and troop types they want, but should endeavor to maintain game and mission balance so that no particular side has an inordinate chance of winning.

Nerves of Steel – Literally.

It should be noted Drones, Robots, fully enclosed vehicles and/or walkers/suits do NOT take a Will check for Deflected Hits. Open jeeps or truck cabs do not count as fully enclosed.

5.4 Indirect Fire

Indirect Fire Weapons

Most weapons are direct fire (i.e. shoot in a straight line). However, weapons listed with this special rule in the Armory are capable of Indirect Fire, meaning they can fire over intervening terrain features.

Indirect Fire Penalty

When using Indirect Fire the Attacker suffers a -1 penalty to their Combat Ability when the Target is in LOS. If no LOS is available but LOF is possible, then the Attacker suffers a -3 penalty to their Combat Ability (They're guessing at the target's location).

The Shadow Rule of Indirect Fire

A unit is said to be in the **shadow** of a tall LOS/LOF blocking terrain feature if it is within a distance equal to the terrain feature's height. For example, a 2" tall wall has a 2" wide shadow from its base.

This unit **cannot** be targeted by Indirect Fire from the other side of the terrain item, **unless** the Attacking unit is also within the same terrain feature's shadow.

The **shadow rule** is here to reflect the nature of indirect fire and parabolic arcs for abstracted game play. It reflects the idea that a munitions' trajectory can't abruptly drop out of a natural arc.

Example

A Bandit is skulking in the other side of a 3" tall concrete wall. There is a Zone Enforcement trooper on the other side of the wall. Since he cannot attack the Bandit with his AK-74, due to blocked LOS/LOF, he decides to toss a hand grenade. To do so, the Zone Enforcement trooper must be within 3" of the wall as well.

Indirect Munitions and Deviation

The Zone Enforcement trooper pulls the pin and lobs his grenade. Hopefully, he was on target. If not, that hand grenade still landed somewhere. Whenever an Indirect Fire attack misses the intended target, determine the actual point of detonation with a single D10 roll.

Roll 1D10 per grenade. Referencing the intended point of impact, the number shown indicates the **half** the distance in inches the grenade deviated from its target, the point (or tip) of the D10 notes the direction it traveled. This is the new impact location. Center the Blast Template on this new point and resolve any damage (Yes, it can land on friendly troops).

A Word To The Wise

You really want my advice, bratok? Leave now, while you still can.

No? Well then find a decent crew and learn to do one job well. Seriously.

Forget trying to master everything. That approach only leaves you good at nothing.

You've got to realize you don't rise to the occasion so much as sink to the level of your training, and if you've trained hard, that's what is going to save you and your comrades. Nothing else.

When the crap hits the fan, and trust me it will, luck favors the prepared.

Oh, and one other thing: never, ever skimp on equipment.

You bought the cheapest gun on the rack trying to save money? I guarantee it'll jam at the worst possible moment.

And a little thing like that can ruin your whole day.